

The background of the slide is decorated with numerous colorful candies and lollipops. These include round candies in red, yellow, green, blue, and purple; striped candies in blue and white, yellow and white, and green and white; spiral lollipops in blue, red, and purple; and other uniquely shaped sweets like a heart-shaped one and a one with a stick. The candies are scattered across the entire slide, framing the central text.

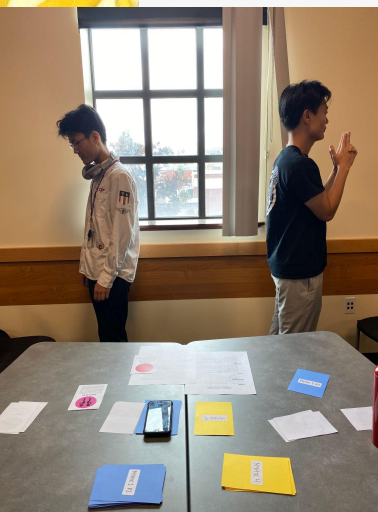
Hansel vs. Gretel

By David Han, Joshua Guico, Ray Pan,
and Anooj Vadodkar



Our Game

- Board game version of an Escape Room, with each player attempting to beat the other and get out of the Witch's house first.
- Players have to guess the mythical being that seals the exit
 - Mythical beings
 - Find clues by participating in physical challenges
- If no player guesses correctly by the final room, whoever won the most physical challenges wins instead.
- Our goal was to make players engage both their bodies and their minds





What We Rolled

Player Interaction Pattern: One Player Vs. One Player

Core Mechanic: Physical Dexterity

Dramatic Premise: Based on a Fairy Tale/Myth

Game Objective: Solution



The Design Process

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- During our first iteration, the main thing that confused us was the game objective, since solution seemed to clash with physical dexterity heavily.
 - Worried that the physical dexterity aspect would undermine the solution, or vice versa
 - Landed on the idea of an escape room early, and with that came basing off Hansel and Gretel
 - Originally had players compete in physical dexterity games to find the key words to unlock a door to escape, but this didn't feel like it qualified for solution.
 - Switched instead to having players compete to guess from a category based on hints obtained by winning our physical dexterity challenges
 - Originally had players guess quotes, then fairy tales, then mythical beings.



The Design Process

- During our first playtest, we found that while the rules of the game were understood quickly, the rules for the challenges were a different story
 - One player who knew the challenges from playing them growing up was able to guide players on what to do, which isn't ideal.
- Also turned out to be a bit confusing for how to play the game with groups of four, since we had one player versus one player as our constraint.
 - Players switched between challenges.
- While players did have fun playing the game, there were areas of refinement that were evident.
 - Certain challenges, specifically arm wrestling, push-ups, sit-ups, and planks didn't fit the category of "dexterity"
 - One group didn't get any hints to guess the mythical being, but still was able to win by a random guess





The Design Process

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- Made refinements for our second playtest, coming in the form of replacing our problematic challenges and including pictures so the challenges were more clear to people who had never played it before.
 - Challenges were easier understood this time, though could still use more refinement
 - Reworded the rules as well to fit our Dramatic Premise of being a still trapped Hansel and Gretel
 - The challenges players got didn't seem to discourage them like push-ups, sit-ups, and planks did
 - As mentioned earlier, some could use better explanations.
 - Changed the system of hint distribution so players could have a chance at a comeback in the third round even if they hadn't been successful earlier
 - Backfired on us a bit during this playtest; the final hint was too obvious compared to the others.
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10/18/2023

		I found the GAMEPLAY to be ENJOYABLE	The CHALLENGES were EASY to understand.	The HINTS were USEFUL in guessing the Mythics.	The GAME RULES were EASY to understand.	Please rate the OVERALL DIFFICULTY of the CHALLENGES	Overall I ENJOYED playing at the level of DIFFICULTY I rated above.	Please rate the OVERALL DIFFICULTY of the GAME	I ENJOYED the DRAMATIC ELEMENTS of the game.	I STAYED ENGAGED during the CHALLENGES	I LEARNED this game QUICKLY
Playtester #	Name	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10
1	Person 1	4	2	3	4	4	4	4	5	5	5
2	Person 2	5	3	4	4	2	4	2	3	4	3
3	Person 3	4	3	4	4	3	4	3	4	4	4
4	Person 4	4	4	5	4	4	3	3	4	3	5
	GROUP AVERAGE	4.25	3	4	4	3.25	3.75	3	4	4	4.25
	GROUP MEDIAN	4	3	4	4	3.5	4	3	4	4	4.5
	AVERAGE FROM LAST TEST	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
	MEDIAN FROM LAST TEST	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a
	AVERAGE DELTA FROM LAST TEST	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!
	MEDIAN DELTA FROM LAST TEST	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!	#VALUE!
	Answers Key				Except for...						
	1 = Strongly disagree				4. Please rate the OVERALL level of DIFFICULTY of the game						
	2 = Disagree				1 = Too easy						
	3 = Neither Agree nor Disagree				2 = Easy						
	4 = Agree				3 = Average						
	5 = Strongly agree				4 = Hard						
					5 = Too hard						



Second Iteration Data

Hansel Vs. Gretel Playtest

10/25/2023

		I found the GAMEPLAY to be ENJOYABLE	The CHALLENGES were EASY to understand.	The HINTS were USEFUL in guessing the Mythics.	The GAME RULES were EASY to understand.	Please rate the OVERALL DIFFICULTY of the CHALLENGES	Overall I ENJOYED playing at the level of DIFFICULTY I rated above.	Please rate the OVERALL DIFFICULTY of the GAME	I ENJOYED the DRAMATIC ELEMENTS of the game.	I STAYED ENGAGED during the CHALLENGES	I LEARNED this game QUICKLY
Playtester #	Name	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10
1	Shaoxuan Liu	5	5	5	5	3	5	3	4	5	5
2	Paul Gomez	4	4	5	5	2	4	2	4	4	4
3	Adam Chead-Udell	4	5	5	4	1	3	2	4	4	5
4	Vinny Peng	4	4	5	5	3	4	3	4	5	5
5	Boston Moreland	4	4	3	4	2	5	3	4	2	4
	GROUP AVERAGE	4.2	4.4	4.6	4.6	2.2	4.2	2.6	4	4	4.6
	GROUP MEDIAN	4	4	5	5	2	4	3	4	4	5
	AVERAGE FROM LAST TEST	4.25	3	4	4	3.25	3.75	3	4	4	4.25
	MEDIAN FROM LAST TEST	4	3	4	4	3.5	4	3	4	4	4.5
	AVERAGE DELTA FROM LAST TEST	0.0	1.4	0.6	0.6	-1.1	0.5	-0.4	0.0	0.0	0.4
	MEDIAN DELTA FROM LAST TEST	0.0	1.0	1.0	1.0	-1.5	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.5
	Answers Key				Except for...						
	1 = Strongly disagree				4. Please rate the OVERALL level of DIFFICULTY of the game						
	2 = Disagree				1 = Too easy						
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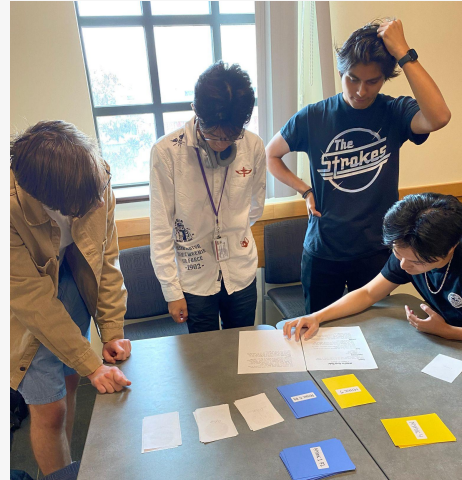
What does the data say?

- The rules of the overall game itself were easy to understand, with our final result showing players agreeing to strongly agreeing on this point.
- How players felt regarding challenge difficulty changed dramatically when we removed push-ups, sit-ups, and planks
 - Also a correlation between the challenge difficulty and how easy challenges were to understand
- Hints were seen as useful by players, with our second playtest seeing multiple players strongly agreeing that they were useful.
- Players really enjoyed the dramatic element!
- Some challenges were more difficult to convey properly than others; More diagrams might help here



So, What's Next?

- Increase the number of physical dexterity challenges, and work on their descriptions
 - Scoped down to nine for class due to time constraints
- Retune already existing challenges so they're as fair as possible
- Add more Mythical Beings as options for players to guess
 - Take from different Myths, let players choose which ones they're comfortable with
- Rebalance the hints so the final hint isn't a dead giveaway
- Create more diagrams for challenges present
- Can potentially expand game to different intellectual properties
 - Instead of mythical beings, can do superheroes, video game characters, TV shows, etc.



Game Design Lessons

- This combination of constraints undoubtedly challenged, but we found success in **focusing** on one aspect first (physical dexterity) then integrating the other later
- Players don't like reading words, **SHOW** the players how to play guns/sticks rather than explaining it to them
- End Game **Balance** is extremely important, the winner should feel triumphant and deserving of the win
- **Specify**, players don't have prior knowledge of what a "mythic" is
- **Brainstorming** too many ideas is better than not enough, we ended up cutting many of our original challenge ideas





Communication Lessons



- Specialists encourage higher productivity and efficiency. Having members focus on dramatic elements, overall rules, challenge rules etc. helped us stay on track
- Explaining challenges to each other helped us formulate the wording for the actual game
- Progress updates regularly ensured everyone played a role and completed tasks in a timely manner
- Active Listening allowed all members to have a say in our game
- Receiving feedback and actually tweaking our game based on our feedback was invaluable



ArchangelDawn 10/17/2023 2:08 PM

We just had an epiphany

Squid games

That's all this is



josh 10/17/2023 2:08 PM

LMFAOOOO

A decorative border of various candies surrounds the central text. On the left side, from top to bottom, there is a blue spiral lollipop, a pink striped lollipop, a yellow and white striped lollipop, a green oval lollipop, and a pink polka-dot lollipop. On the right side, from top to bottom, there is a yellow round lollipop, a red lollipop, a purple spiral lollipop, a green and white striped lollipop, and a blue oval lollipop. The word "Thanks!" is written in a large, bold, red, hand-drawn font in the center of the image.

Thanks!